- Git (optional)

> *This lab uses **PHP 8.4**, **Laravel 12** and **Visual Studio Code** as the primary editor.*

14.13.4 Steps

Here are the steps to complete this lab:

14.13.4.1 Step 1: Create a New Laravel 12 Project

Open your terminal and run:

```
laravel new file-upload-api
cd file-upload-api
code .
```

Accept the default options when prompted. This will create a new Laravel project named `file-upload-api` with SQLite database and open it in Visual Studio Code.

You should see the Laravel project structure in your code editor.

14.13.4.2 Step 2: Configure Database

Since we are using default SQLite database, we can verify to configure open the `.env` file.

```
DB_CONNECTION=sqlite
```

14.13.4.3 Step 3: Enable API Support in Laravel 12

Laravel 12 **does not enable API routing by default**. Activate API support by running:

```
php artisan install:api
```

This command:

✔ Creates the `routes/api.php` file
✔ Configures **middleware** for API authentication
✔ Installs Laravel Sanctum for **API security**

When you run the command, you may asked to perform migraations. You can skip it for now. Type `no` and press `Enter`. We will run the migrations later.